

he also notes the cyclical nature of production.

According to Vivek Srivatsa, Chief Commercial Officer of Tata Passenger Electric Mobility, customers can expect benefits of up to ₹2.05 lakh on internal combustion engine vehicles, in addition to offers on cash payment.

Such offers are expected to continue in the next few months, with larger discounts anticipated in December.

Anurag Singh, MD at management consulting firm Primus Partners, believes discounts will likely extend beyond the immediate festive period as automakers aim to clear inventory.

Singh attributes the high

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DISCOUNTS ON AUTOMOBILES WILL LIKELY EXTEND BEYOND THE IMMEDIATE FESTIVE PERIOD

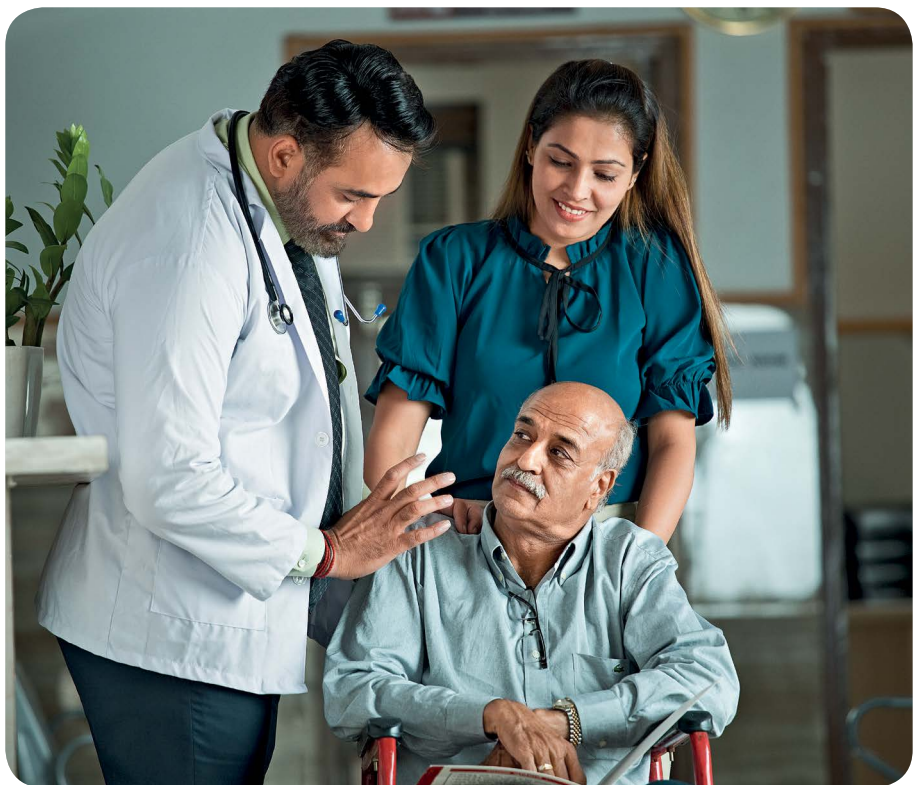
inventory to automakers' desire to capture market share. "As the competition intensifies, automakers will want to gain market share, and hence they will have excess inventory. And thus discounts," he explains.

Interestingly, companies that usually do not offer discounts, such as Toyota and Honda, have also joined the trend. Toyota Kirloskar Motor is offering discounts worth ₹49,914, while Honda Motor India is offering up to ₹33,930 in savings.

As the festive season unfolds, both e-commerce and the automobile industry are pulling out all the stops to capture consumer interest. With deep discounts and faster delivery, the holiday season is expected to show robust consumer demand. **BT**

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PHOTO BY GETTY IMAGES



GROWING NEED The scheme will provide health cover of ₹5 lakh

HEALTHCARE

CARING FOR THE ELDERLY

Healthcare providers welcome extension of AB PM-JAY, but say some issues need to be addressed

BY NEETU CHANDRA SHARMA

► **THE UNION CABINET'S** recent decision to extend health coverage under the Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY) to all senior citizens aged 70 and above is set to benefit over 60 million people across India. But experts say that the government must address concerns around re-

imbursements to ensure that the scheme is a success.

The AB PM-JAY currently covers 550 million individuals from 123.4 million families across 33 states and Union Territories and has facilitated 73.7 million hospital admissions, with women comprising 49% of beneficiaries. The